

AN APPEAL

THE AGONY OF BIHAR



CARE TODAY
AN INDIA TODAY GROUP INITIATIVE



UNENDING WOES: People escape the flood-affected areas and move to relief camps

—S. SAHANI

We all are aware of the flood situation in Bihar—the river Kosi has breached its banks and flooded 775 villages and left 2.2 million people without homes, food, land, and a future. Rescue operations are under severe stress because of the large numbers affected, and relief and rehabilitation are going to be more so. The prime minister has declared it a national disaster and allotted a sum of Rs 1,000 crore for relief activities.

CARE TODAY was formed in 1999, in the aftermath of the Kargil War, to act as a link between readers, viewers and listeners of the India Today Group and problems that the nation is facing and that one wishes to do something about. We have since responded to earthquakes (in Gujarat and Kashmir), droughts (in Rajasthan and Gujarat), cyclone (in Orissa) and a tsunami—working with the worst-affected areas and communities in each case to ensure their survival and long-term welfare. We have done this using the highest standards of openness and

transparency. India Today Group's vehicles of Aajtak, India Today and Mail Today have been used to report back to contributors on the usage of funds.

We need your support once again—this time for the flood-affected people of Bihar. We would like to supplement immediate relief work in flood-affected districts, and go on to involvement in rehabilitation activities. We are already in discussions with institutions that are active on the ground and will make specific plans once the rescue phase of operations is over and the situation is clearer.

CARE TODAY makes its usual commitments—we will ensure that our work benefits the worst-affected communities, we will ensure that it addresses real needs, and we will report back to you on the progress that we have made. The India Today Group will make the first contribution of Rs 10 lakh to CARE TODAY towards this cause. All contributions of Rs 5,000 and more will be acknowledged in India Today.

YOU CAN MAKE A DIFFERENCE

Please draw cheques or demand drafts in favour of CARE TODAY A/c Bihar Flood Relief Fund and send to:

CARE TODAY,

Hamilton House, A-1, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110 001, India.

Contributions are eligible for tax exemption under Section 80(G) of the Income Tax Act.

For any queries, please contact Ajit Chaudhuri or Skalzang Youdon at

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